

FRANKLY SPEAKING...

PARTNER EDITION | OCTOBER 2026

FOR REAL ESTATE AGENTS, CPAs, BUILDERS, AND REFERRAL PARTNERS

Useful insight. Better client conversations.

Local market context, financing options, and ideas you can put to work.



Market Moves

OCTOBER PLAY | SEPTEMBER SIGNALS

More choice. Payment pressure.

Nashville-Davidson / Murfreesboro-Franklin
MSA

The signal

September inventory grew 12% year over year; 22.5% of listings had a price reduction. More choice, more comparisons.

Mortgage Mood

Cautious and payment-focused. Freddie Mac's national 30-year average reached 7.28% on Oct. 1, up from 7.03% a week earlier. Plan around today's quote; a quick rate drop is not assured.

The move

Review competing listings and showing feedback. Pair your property story with a realistic payment conversation.

Bring a financing question

Ask our team for a personalized comparison of a price adjustment and seller closing-cost credit. Verify program limits before advertising.

Sources: Realtor.com (Sept.); Freddie Mac (Oct. 1).
National benchmark; mood is our interpretation.

Program Spotlight

JMAC FHA Combo

For clients whose down payment savings need a closer look, this program pairs an FHA first mortgage with an assistance second mortgage.

- **Assistance:** 3.5% or 5% of the lower of purchase price or appraised value.
- **Credit:** 600 with automated approval; 620 for manual underwriting. Manual DTI limit: 45%.
- **Financing:** 96.5% first-mortgage LTV; 100% or 101.5% maximum combined LTV.
- **Eligibility:** No income cap or first-time buyer requirement. Homebuyer education required.

Explain the second mortgage

Repayable options have a 10-year term, monthly payments, and a rate 2 percentage points above the first mortgage. The 3.5% forgivable option has no interest or monthly payments; forgiveness after three years requires meeting its conditions.

JMAC guidelines, revised 9/4/2026. Early first-mortgage payoff may require repayment of the forgivable second. Other costs may remain. Approval and program conditions apply.

MARKET MAGNETISM + A PROMPT YOU CAN PUT TO WORK

Market Magnetism

Give Your Listing a Story Beyond Beds and Baths

A feature list tells people what a home has. Show them how the space works. This month's play: turn three verified property features into a week of useful content.

1. Choose the story.

Pick three standout features. Show a flexible room, outdoor space, or practical storage with specific, accurate details.

2. Film one simple walkthrough.

Record a 30-second video showing those features. Add your own observations so viewers hear your voice.

3. Give each post one next step.

Invite viewers to request property details or schedule a showing. Keep the listing link easy to find.

4. Track what brings a reply.

Compare property inquiries, showing requests, and meaningful replies. Use those questions in your next post.

Prompt of the Month

One Listing, Five Hooks, a Fuller Story

Copy into ChatGPT or Claude and replace the brackets:

Act as a real estate copywriter. Help me earn attention for this listing with specific, accurate opening lines.

Verified facts: [location, property details, three standout features]

My voice: [warm, direct, conversational, etc.]

Next step: [request details or schedule a showing]

Write five different Facebook opening hooks, each 12 words or fewer: a standout feature, a practical benefit, a question, a contrast between two verified features, and a moment someone could experience in the space.

Choose the strongest hook. Write a 150–200-word Facebook post developing three verified features into a property story. Explain practical uses without assuming who the buyer is. Include location, price, beds, baths, and square footage naturally. End with my chosen next step.

Use specific descriptions, not generic praise or a repeated fact list. If details are insufficient, ask three focused questions first. Never invent facts to reach the word count, create false urgency, or make unsupported claims about schools, safety, financing, or who should live here.

Inspired by the new-listing Facebook prompt in AI Prompts (Realtor), p. 5; rewritten for this edition.

Put it to work: Check the facts and read it aloud. Does it explain what makes this property worth a closer look? Revise until it sounds like you, then track inquiries across posts.

[STALLED LISTING RESCUE PLAN →](#)

[BUYER INCENTIVES →](#)

[DISCUSS A CLIENT →](#)

BEHIND THE CLOSING + A READY-TO-SEND INTRODUCTION

Behind the Closing

The Builder's Preferred Lender Had Another Path

An anonymous past transaction | Shelbyville, Tennessee

The challenge: A builder advertised a \$99 contract and \$99 closing costs with its preferred lender. Our buyer needed to understand how that incentive and their financing could work together.

The approach: The builder's preferred lender was also one of our lending partners. Working through that relationship, we arranged zero down and a \$1,500 lender credit for this buyer.

The finish: A missed closing date, an extension, and lender-system issues made this one a workout. We worked through the obstacles, and the buyer closed.

The agent takeaway: Send the written incentive terms before assuming there is only one route. Let's review the lender relationship and the buyer's options together.

Past transaction; terms were specific to that buyer. Similar incentives, eligibility, and outcomes are not guaranteed.

Current Rate Examples

Pricing supplied October 2, 2026 at 4:05 p.m. Central. Subject to change.

Program / Down	Rate	APR	Lender Credit
Conventional 20%	7.250%	7.280%	\$694
Conventional 5%	7.250%	8.005%	\$2,250
FHA 3.5%	6.375%	7.1222%	\$1,465
USDA 0%	6.375%	6.824%	\$495
VA 0%	6.375%	6.610%	\$173

Assumptions: \$400,000 purchase; 680 credit; 30-year fixed; single-family primary residence; 30-day lock. Credits and terms require eligibility review. Not a commitment to lend.

Partner Play: Make the Introduction Easy

"Hi [Client], meet Frank Burks, the mortgage advisor I mentioned. Frank, [Client] is thinking about buying around [timeframe] and would like to discuss [main question]. With their permission, I'm connecting you to talk about options and next steps."

Have a listing or buyer scenario? Let's talk.

Call/text **615.364.5700** | [Book a scenario conversation](#)